

otechnology will be at such a level that we'll basically be immortal cyborgs. The American - dubbed the smartest futurist on Earth by Microsoft founder Bill Gates - has consistently predicted new technologies many years before they arrived. According to Ray



Evolution into Cyborgs

- ▶ In around 20 years, nanotechnology will equip us with the means to reprogramme our bodies' stone-age software so we can halt, then reverse, ageing.
- ▶ Nanobots, blood cell-sized submarines, are being tested in animals and they will soon be used to destroy tumors, unblock clots and perform operations without scars. Ultimately, nanobots will replace blood cells and do their work thousands of times more effectively.
- ▶ Within 25 years we will be able to do an Olympic sprint for 15 minutes without taking a breath, or go scuba-diving for four hours without oxygen.
- ▶ Heart-attack victims - who haven't taken advantage of widely available bionic hearts - will calmly drive to the doctors for a minor operation as their blood bots keep them alive.
- ▶ If we want to go into virtual-reality mode, nanobots will shut down brain signals and take us wherever we want to go. Virtual sex will become commonplace. And in our daily lives, hologram-like figures will pop up in our brain to explain what is happening.

These technologies should not seem at all fanciful. Mobile phones are a perfect example. Our phones now perform tasks we wouldn't have dreamed possible 20 years ago. Today our mobile phone is a million times less expensive and a thousand times more powerful, than a computer 20 years back. That translates to a capability that's a billion times more but for the same price. In a similar manner we will experience another billion-fold increase in technological capability for the same cost in the next 25 years.

So we can look forward to a world where humans become cyborgs, with artificial limbs and organs.

Cyborg Soldiers

Cyborg soldiers are a logical evolutionary link between humans and robots. Yesterday's soldier went into combat alone. Today's soldier is enhanced by human controlled robots. Tomorrow's soldier will be a soldier cyborg, a cybernetic